

A2D Individual Project Reflection

Assignment 2 was a fun and challenging project to complete. There were some difficulties I have to overcome and make some supplements to complete its features, but the end product from my efforts felt rewarded. Creating this project had helped me further develop my skills in coding, improve my design based on the feedback I receive and how my project will look in the end.

This project is based on the Clock concept, which would mean that I must design an abstract project relating to time. I wanted to do something simple yet seemingly ambitious so that I can easily develop the project while having fun before the submission due date. That led to me thinking of showing the effect of time underwater because it would look nice, simple and pretty to look at. Then planned to add some fishes and environmental aspects so that there can be something to look at and have a flashlight and make the fishes go into hiding for the interactions and sounds. Although the concept not very unique, I am satisfied about my concept idea since it was what I believe is manageable to complete for the assignment.

During the development, implementing the time concept was a bit difficult than I expected. I thought it would be simple to show the environmental lighting loop of brightening, darkening and back again though lerp. However, I realised that method will not work since I would have to keep track of every object on the scene, which will take time, and that it would be complicated to implement the flashlight interaction I planned to add. This led to some research and inspirations to let me develop a dark overlay over the scene, that changes its transparency and have a transparent yellow hole to act as the flashlight focus. This was successful as I can freely switch the mode of the flashlight interaction and see the dark and bright side of the environment.

Creating the fish was easy to make since I planned to have its design and movement to be simple. I made it as a class object so that I could make the design and functions of a fish. I have it drawn using the translation tools and geometric shapes to create its body, tail and eyes. I then created the functions that move the fishes around the canvas where it bounces off the edges and, as another interaction feature that was suggested, go in the opposite direction when the flashlight shines near their face. To make the fishes livelier, I have its tail to wiggle to show some life and possess slightly different speeds and hide durations to make them more variant on the scene. I also made the fish leave the canvas and change its colour when the afternoon or midnight time happens to represent the AM and PM. For things that need improving, I would like to have more variety of fishes that differ in shape, size and colour. However, I believe my design of the fishes have kept my design of the project consistent in its art, and that made the project nice to look at.

The environment of my project is simply a solid blue background with seaweed and rocks. This is achieved by using the background and image function to produce the colour and image, which helps add more life in the scene of fishes. I would have liked to show a gradient from light to dark from the top to show the light shining from above, but I believe that would be difficult to achieve, especially when I have to consider the many fishes moving around the canvas. Regardless, the simple 2D environment fits the aesthetic of the project perfectly, which blends into the graphics well.

Overall, the project for Assignment 2 is an underwater environment with fishes based on the Clock concept. The process of the development was enjoyable and has some challenges in creating the interaction and environmental lighting features. While some of the designs could have more details to them, the simplistic look and its interactions of the project make it look pleasuring and fun.